
LaunchLab 6

Lesson 6: Introduction to GitHub and Vercel

What is GitHub



1. Store

Keep all your project files and their history in one location. This place is called the repository.

2. Share

Easily make your work accessible. You can make it public so that anyone can see, use, and learn from what you have done.

3. Collaborate

Work with your friends or coworkers without overwriting each other's codebase.



Key Terms



1. Grab an existing project

Fork: Make your own copy of someone else's repo on your GitHub account, so you can change it without affecting the original.

Clone: Copy a repo from GitHub down onto your computer so you can edit the files locally.

2. Save and upload your work

Commit: Save a snapshot of your current changes, along with a short note describing what you did. This will save locally and NOT on GitHub.

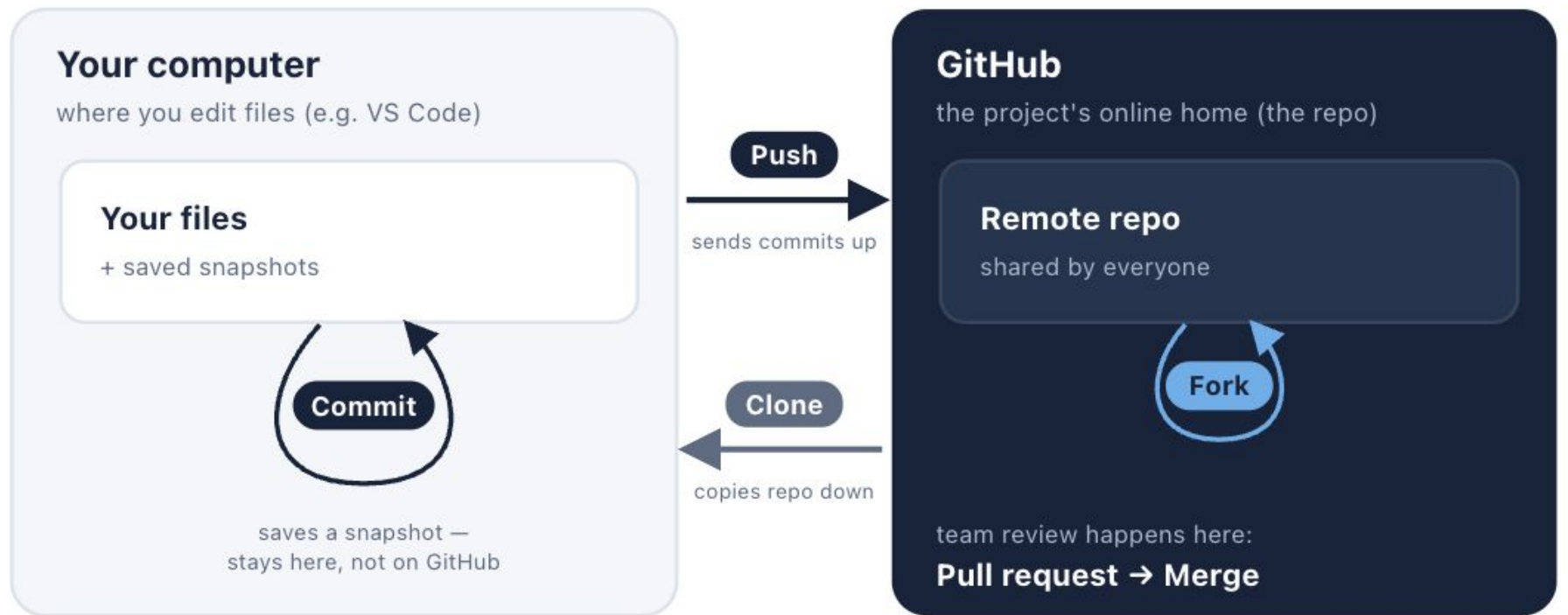
Push: Send the commits you saved on your computer up to GitHub, so the online copy is up to date.

3. Combine work with a team

Pull Request (PR): Propose your changes and ask teammates to review them before they get added to the main project.

Merge: Approve the changes from a pull request and combine them into the main version of the project.

How It Works



Most Git actions just move your work between these two copies.

How a Repository Looks



The screenshot displays the GitHub 'My contributions' page. The left sidebar contains navigation links: 'My contributions' (selected), 'My repositories', 'My forks', and 'Admin access'. Below these are 'Views' and 'No saved views'. The main content area is titled 'My contributions' and features a search bar with the filter 'contributed-by:@me'. A green 'New repository' button is in the top right. The repository list shows three items:

- yiboyang-sas/ddoubleup** (Private): TypeScript, 0 stars, 0 forks, 0 pulls, updated 3 weeks ago.
- yiboyang-sas/doubleup** (Public): TypeScript, 0 stars, 0 forks, 0 pulls, updated 3 weeks ago.
- yiboyang-sas/whartondatasciencecompetition** (Private): SAS WDSC, Jupyter Notebook, 0 stars, 0 forks, 0 pulls, updated on Feb 24.

A 'ProTip!' message at the bottom states: 'Don't forget that you can create saved views to keep track of your most important repositories!'. The bottom right corner shows profile icons for the user and a bot.

Push vs Pull Request



Push

Direct Action:

Uploads your commits straight to repo - no waiting, no approval.

No Review:

Changes go live immediately on whatever branch you push to.

Use When:

Working solo or on your own branch and you're confident in your changes.



Pull Request

Request for Review:

Propose your changes and asks teammates to look before anything is merged.

Discussion:

Others can comment, suggest edits, and approve or reject the changes.

Use When:

Working on a team or contributing to someone else's project.

Intro to Vercel



**This is similar
to `tiiny.host`!**



1. Connect

Link your GitHub repo to Vercel once.
From then on, Vercel watches that repo
for you.

2. Deploy

Every time you push, Vercel grabs the
new code and updates your live site in
seconds — no manual uploading, ever.

3. Preview

Every pull request gets its own preview
link, so your team can see the changes
before merging them.

What's the difference between GitHub and Vercel?

GitHub stores your code — every file, every version, shared with your team. But nothing there is a website yet.

Vercel turns that code into one. It reads your repo, builds the site, and hosts it at a public link that updates every time you push.

Step 1: Get Your Code Into GitHub



1. Make A Repo

Sign in to github.com → click the green **New repository** button. Name it, keep it **Public**, click **Create**.

2. Let Claude Code Push It

Copy your new repo's URL, then paste the prompt below into Claude Code. It runs the git commands for you.

3. Check It Worked

Refresh your repo page. Your files should be there - that's your first **commit** and **push**.

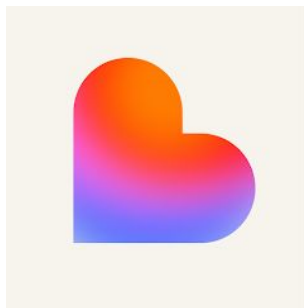
Type This Into Claude Code

"Push this project to Github. Initialise a git repo, commit everything with a clear message, and push it to **<paste your repo URL>**."

If it asks you to sign in to GitHub, follow its instructions in the terminal.

Using Lovable Instead?

You don't need any of this. Open your project - **Settings** - **GitHub** - **Connect**. Lovable creates the repo, pushes your code automatically, and keeps it in sync from then on. Skip to Step 2.



Step 2: Connect To Vercel



1. Sign In With Github

Go to **vercel.com** and sign up using your **GitHub account** — not email. This is what lets Vercel see your repos.

2. Import Your Repo

On your dashboard, click **New Project** → **Import Git Repository** → pick the repo you pushed in Step 1. Authorize Vercel when GitHub asks.

3. Deploy

Vercel auto-detects your setup. Click **Deploy**, wait a few seconds, and you get a **live public link**.

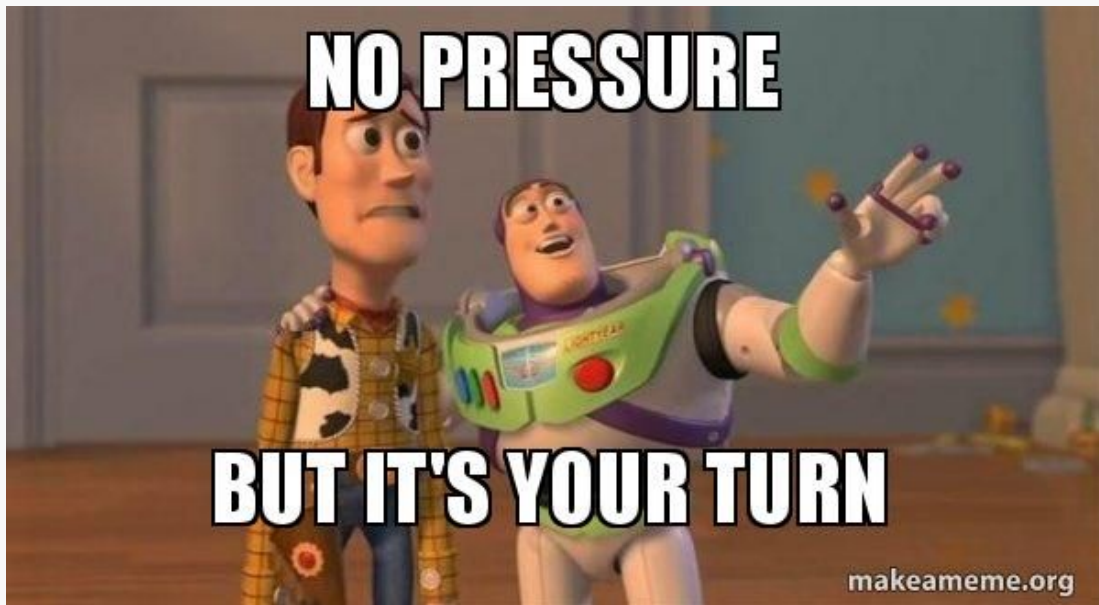
From now on, you never upload anything again.

Every time you push to GitHub, Vercel rebuilds and updates your live site automatically. And every pull request gets its own preview link, so your team can see changes before merging.

Task



Take your latest project from Claude or Lovable and send it to GitHub. Then, transfer it to Vercel.



Next Lesson: GitHub Branching and Collaboration

Homework: Find an open source project on GitHub that interests you. Fork it and send it to Vercel. Also review new terms that were covered today - VERY IMPORTANT!